Universal token system · Phase 7

The universal token system, whole.

Seven phases, one coherent vocabulary — what it means, how it is used, and a CI gate that keeps it that way.

Organized on two axes.

Abstraction

Primitive, then Semantic, then Component. What it means flows into how it is used.

Render shape

css-rich (live cascade) vs bridge-flat (the offline Mermaid resolver) — now both evaluate the same expressions.

Foreground

Ink, stroke, mark — painted on something. Named for its background with `on-`.

Background

Surface, fill — things sit on it. Takes the bare role name.

Seven phases, each byte-identical.

Categorical · structural

`--cat-N-fill/mark/on-fill/on-mark` and `--diagram-stroke/line`.

Status · lifecycle

`--status-*` for the engine + charts; `--diagram-active/done/critical` for gantt.

Surfaces · sequential

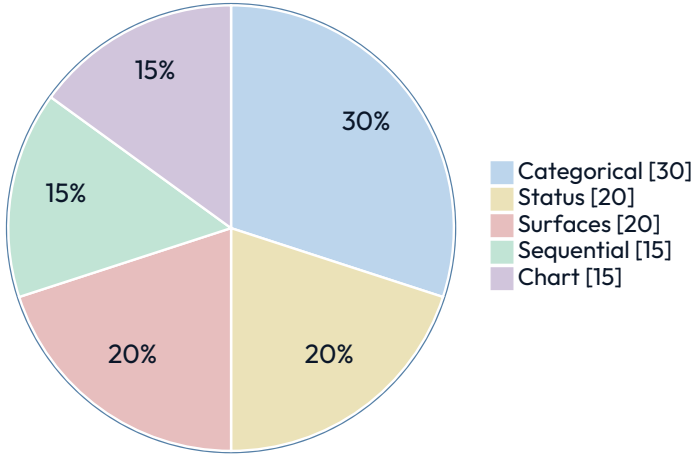
`--surface-inverse` + `--scheme-dark-*`; `--seq-*` frees "scale".

Chart · self-policing

`--chart-cat-*` ends the bare-cat collision; a CI gate guards the vocabulary.

Proof

And it all still renders.



KEY INSIGHT

Every color above resolves through the new names across all three render paths — light and dark, fourteen palettes, zero visual change.

Phase 7 of 7 · engineering/decisions/2026-06-11-universal-token-system.md

A boardroom-ready token system, built to scale.